The main difference between the two is that opinion poll is conducted before the voter actually votes and the exit poll is conducted after a voter comes out after casting his or her vote. Results of exit polls are generally considered to be more trustworthy than that of opinion polls.

The result of opinion polls may or may not actually collaborate the actual results. Yet they are important in generating opinions among the unsure and undecided as well as help to sustain a balance in voting practices for all parties concerned.

Glossary



Political Party: An organization that seeks to achieve political power by electing its members to public office

One-party system: A system in which a single political party has the right to form the government, usually based on the existing constitution, or where only one party has the exclusive control over political power

Two-party system: A system where only two parties or alliances, typically placed either side of the centre, have a realistic chance of forming a majority. Other parties are very minor or solely regional.

Multi-party system: A system in which multiple political parties have the capacity to gain control of government offices, separately or in coalition.

Ballot: This piece of paper contains information on the symbols and names of the candidates contesting in a constituency.

By-election: When a seat in Legislature becomes vacant between general elections (often because the incumbent has either resigned, defected to another party or died), a by-election is held.

Election: The process whereby eligible persons vote to determine who will hold a political office.

Elector: A person who is included in the electoral roll for an electorate.

Election Commission: The Election Commission is an independent autonomous entity responsible for the administration of Parliamentary and State Legislature Assembly elections and related works.

Ballot box : The box at a polling place into which a stamped ballot paper is to be dropped.

Coalition:A Government is formed by more than one party when no single party sets absolute majority.

Electoral roll: The list of all the registered electors for a particular electorate kept by the Registrar of Electors.

Electoral System: The general name for all the rules concerning elections, i.e. the voting system, boundaries, registration of electors, candidacy, campaign spending, broadcasting, etc.

Majority Government; A government made up of one or more political parties is formed by a political party which has absolute majority in legislature.

Democracy: Government by the people, through free, fair and periodical elections.

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